# THE ELON GAZETTE

*Weekday briefing on what Elon Musk is saying and doing*

TUESDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2026


THE MORNING PICTURE

## "Directly to the people is the way"

A day after pledging one SpaceX share to every American child, Elon Musk spent Monday defending the idea and thanking the people behind the delivery mechanism. President Trump announced that the shares will go through Trump Accounts, the tax-advantaged accounts for children, The Verge reported; 72 million shares would be worth about $10.5 billion at Friday's price.

SpaceX reports quarterly results after Tuesday's close and Tesla on Wednesday. In between, Musk announced changes to how X ranks posts, kept promoting the Grok Bot agent, and Tesla's board urged shareholders to keep him on its board, calling him "the architect of our transformation."

I · SPACEX

## The share gift finds a home

*Trump Accounts will carry the shares; a follower asked Musk to keep them away from State Street.*

**72M**
shares, one per U.S. child, worth about $10.5 billion at Friday's close

**70M+**
Trump Accounts created, the White House has said

**4:30 p.m.**
EDT Tuesday: SpaceX's third-quarter webcast

"Yes, giving shares, which are stakes in the future economy, directly to the people is the way," Musk replied at 11:58 a.m. EDT Monday to a post praising the gift for "bypassing the state completely." To investor Brad Gerstner, who called it "the largest philanthropic gift in history," he wrote, "Thanks for helping enable this." Trump then said the shares would be given through Trump Accounts; Michael and Susan Dell, Ray and Barbara Dalio, Gerstner and SpaceX President Gwynne Shotwell have also promised contributions to the accounts, The Verge noted.

Overnight, a shareholder asked him to "ensure the default investment option for Trump Accounts is no longer State Street," citing the firm's proxy votes. "Noted," Musk answered.

SpaceX launched its Bandwagon-5 rideshare, carrying the second flight of its Starfall return capsule, at 7:04 a.m. EDT Tuesday (SpaceX). Its third-quarter results come after the close, with an audio-only webcast at 4:30 p.m. EDT (SpaceX); analysts polled by LSEG expect revenue of about $12.74 billion, Reuters reported.

II · X & GROK

## A new ranking model for the timeline

*"User active seconds is growing exponentially," Musk wrote Monday night.*

Musk announced "two important changes to timeline recommendations" at 10:41 p.m. EDT Monday: a "new AI/SI ranking model that predicts probable time spent much better" and a "retrieval model trained to surface posts people read all the way through." Rewriting X's Android app "was also a big deal," he added. "It was really bad for such a long time."

QUICK HIT

**Credit where due.** "Have to give the EU regulators credit where it's due for making all Apple products use USB-C," Musk posted Monday night. When a follower pushed back, he replied: "USB-C firmware is complex."

He kept selling Grok Bot, the AI agent from SpaceX's AI unit. Quoting a post that said going back to a chat window "with an AI that can't get things done" is hard, he wrote: "Grok Bot

might turn out to be your favorite employee." To a user who said people can "just spin up a new bot and tell it what you need," he replied, "True, try Grok Bot." Under a "silly shower thought" from programmer John Carmack, he wrote: "Grok's engineering analysis is good."

III · TESLA

# "The architect of our transformation"

*Tesla's board opened its campaign to re-elect Musk; results come Wednesday.*



Building 1 at Tesla's Gigafactory Texas near Austin, shown on June 17, 2022. Tesla's annual meeting will be held there on December 3.
PHOTO: LARRY D. MOORE / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC BY 4.0 (CROPPED)

"This year, we're asking you to vote 'FOR' all three proposals on the ballot, including the re-election of Elon Musk, Robyn Denholm and JB Straubel to Tesla's Board," Tesla posted Monday. In a letter filed that evening, the board calls Musk "the architect of our transformation" and says "continuity of leadership matters" (SEC). The meeting is December 3 at Gigafactory Texas and online.

The letter says paid FSD (Supervised) customers are nearing 1.5 million and that Robotaxi now runs in seven U.S. cities. Tesla began rolling out FSD v14.3.13 on Tuesday, with a rewritten AI compiler that the release notes say cuts reaction time by 20%, Not a Tesla App reported. Tesla's third-quarter results come Wednesday after the close.

IV · INTERVIEWS & APPEARANCES

# Two earnings calls in two days

*No new interviews since Monday's issue.*

### Coming up

Tuesday, October 20, 4:30 p.m. EDT: SpaceX's audio-only third-quarter webcast, also streamed on X (SpaceX). Wednesday, October 21, 5:30 p.m. EDT: Tesla's third-quarter webcast (8-K).

Thursday, December 3, 4:00 p.m. EST: Tesla's annual meeting, at Gigafactory Texas and online; in-person seats go by drawing, with entries closing at 12:59 a.m. EST on November 7 (VoteTesla).

## Takeaways

1. Musk's SpaceX share gift will go through Trump Accounts.
2. He said a new ranking model now powers X's timeline.
3. Tesla's board called him "the architect of our transformation."
4. SpaceX reports Tuesday after the close, Tesla on Wednesday.

## Sources

Posts by @elonmusk, @Tesla and @SpaceX.

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